

fssai

INDIA@75

FREEDOM FROM TRANS FATS FOR A HEALTHY FUTURE

As the world today transforms at a brisk pace, health and nutrition need a sharper focus to ensure a healthy future for citizens. In line with this, the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India, an apex food regulator in the country, is making constant efforts to transform the country's food system to ensure safe, healthy and sustainable food for all Indians.

Today, with rapid urbanization and changing lifestyle, dietary patterns have shifted towards pre- packed foods, frozen foods, fast food including fried foods and desserts etc., which are generally high in salt, sugar, fats, and even trans fats. In India, a variety of foods are prepared e.g., sweets, bakery products, namkeens etc., which may contain trans fats. Also, repeated heating of cooking oil leads to formation of Total Polar Compounds (TPC) which are toxic in nature and may cause health risks such as hypertension, heart diseases, etc.

The Hon'ble Prime Minister, Shri Narendra Modi Ji's vision for a new India@75 years of the country's independence emphasises on health for all, holistic nutrition and freedom from malnutrition. With targeted push for mandatory fortification of rice and availability of fortified seeds to deal with micronutrient deficiencies, preventive healthcare for holistic health and wellness of people through programs like Eat Right India and FIT India etc., the Government of India is dedicated to work towards a reformed and healthy India under the abled leadership of the Prime Minister.

To align with the vision, the government has been working on building health and wellness infrastructure focusing on preventive healthcare to reduce the burden of non-communicable diseases and associated risk factors, especially related to unhealthy diets, foods high in salt, sugar and trans fats. FSSAI had conceptualised a campaign, "India@75: Freedom from trans fat by 2022" in the year 2018 to tackle the issue of trans fats. On one hand, FSSAI started nudging the food industry to voluntarily come forward and pledge to reduce fat, sugar and salt content in foods and eliminate trans fats from oils, fats and food products. At the same time, FSSAI had set up the regulations to limit the levels of trans fats in oils & fats and food products in a phased manner to reach the target of not more than 2% by January 2022.